Introduction and Background

Before Paul says one word about persecution, prophecy, or correction, he reminds a young, suffering church where it came from and who it is — a church "in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ."

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Where this study fits

2 Thessalonians · seven studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–2
Introduction and Background

02 1:3–12
Paul's Admiration for the Thessalonians

03 2:1–5
Confusion Concerning the Coming

04 2:6–12
The Removal of the Restrainer

05 2:13–17
The Day of the Lord and Believers

06 3:1–12
Serving While Waiting

07 3:13–18
My Brother's Keeper

Grace and peace frame the letter (1:2; 3:16–18): persecution in chapter 1, prophecy in chapter 2, correction in chapter 3.

The road to Thessalonica

B · The background geographically (Acts 15:36–18:11)



What Paul taught new believers

- Prophecy — “Jesus is coming”
- And it strengthened them

Why a second letter? · Study Note

- Persecution had intensified (1:4–7)
- A false claim the Day had come (2:1–2)
- Some had stopped working (3:6–12)

Three men, one letter

2 Thessalonians 1:1a · C.1 — Paul and his companions

Paul
Παῦλος G3972

- Just “Paul” — no title
- Their friend, the one they loved
- Contrast Galatians 1:1

Silvanus
Σιλουανός G4610

- The senior member (Silas)
- Jerusalem leader, prophet, Roman citizen
- A co-founder of this church

Timothy
Τιμόθεος G5095

- The leader in training
- Sent back to establish them (1 Thess 3:2)
- Later pastor at Ephesus

Paul comes to this church as a friend, not as an authority enforcing correction.

The church’s true address

2 Thessalonians 1:1b · C.2.a–c — The church, in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ

A

Any assembly

A secular word — even Diana’s worshipers

Acts 19:32

B

Church universal

“I will build My church” — Pentecost to Rapture

Matt 16:18

C

Local church

“Tell it to the church”

Matt 18:17

D

Of the Thessalonians

Identified by its people, not a building

ἐκκλησία · 1:1

In God our Father
ἐν · πατήρ in · Father

- Security, love, strength
- “our Father” — not just “the Father”

And the Lord Jesus Christ
κύριος · Ἰησοῦς · Χριστός

- Lord — deity · Jesus — deliverer
- Christ — Messiah, the Anointed One

Grace and peace — from one source

2 Thessalonians 1:2 · C.2.d–e — The greeting and its source

Grace
χάρις charis · G5485

- Not just unmerited favor —
- favor in spite of demerit
- We deserve judgment; He gives grace

Peace
εἰρήνη eirēnē · G1515

- Shalom: wholeness, welfare
- Peace with God — settled at faith
- The peace of God — for daily trouble

From
ἀπό apo · G575

- One preposition governs both persons
- Father and Son — one source
- A witness to Christ's deity

Grace and peace frame the whole letter (1:2; 3:16, 18) — the persecution of chapter 1, the prophecy of chapter 2, and the correction of chapter 3.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 1:1–2 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Paul writes simply “Paul,” not “Paul the apostle.” Why does that matter here, and how does it compare with Galatians and Corinthians?

2. How does the teacher define grace, and what does peace mean? Why does grace come before peace?

Apply

Live at Your True Address

Write “in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ” on a card and keep it where you’ll see it each morning.

Receive Favor in Spite of Demerit

Each day this week, thank God by name for one specific grace you did not deserve.

In one line: Before any correction, Paul reminds a suffering church who it is — in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ, under grace and peace.